

VIDEO EDITING • AI PRODUCTION

# AI VIDEO GENERATION WORKFLOW

*The exact three-tool process I use to turn a single frame into a finished, cinematic AI-generated video clip — for scene continuations, dramatic reveals, and B-roll that would be impossible to film.*

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A workflow guide by Zohaib — Video Editor

Portfolio: <https://zohaib20128-cyber.github.io/Portfolio/>

# What this guide covers

Three tools, one repeatable pipeline — from a still frame to a finished AI-generated shot.

This is the process I actually use to generate the AI video clips inside my own content — moments where a still image needs to come to life for a few seconds: a scene continuing forward, a reveal, a piece of B-roll that would be too expensive, too dangerous, or simply impossible to film for real. It is not a single magic prompt. It's a small pipeline of three tools, each doing one job well.

|                                                                                                       |                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Your video editor</b><br>Premiere Pro, CapCut, or anything else                                    | Used to capture the exact first frame the AI clip will begin from.             |
| <b>ChatGPT</b><br><a href="https://chatgpt.com">chatgpt.com</a>                                       | Turns your rough scene idea into a long, structured, model-ready video prompt. |
| <b>Google Flow (Veo)</b><br><a href="https://labs.google/fx/tools/flow">labs.google/fx/tools/flow</a> | Generates the actual video clip from your first frame + the prompt.            |

## THE PIPELINE, AT A GLANCE

CAPTURE FRAME → WRITE PROMPT → GENERATE CLIP → EDIT & SPEED-RAMP

Below are two methods for the middle step — writing the prompt. Method 1 is the full, conversational version. Method 2 is a fixed template that gets you the same result faster. Both are covered in full. My own recommendation is Method 2.

## Step-by-step: screenshot & conversational prompting

The full manual process — slower, but useful when you want to explain the scene in your own words.

### 01 Capture your first frame

Pause your edit on the exact frame you want the AI clip to begin from, and take a screenshot in Full HD (1920×1080 minimum).

The AI treats this image as ground truth — a soft or compressed screenshot produces a soft, inconsistent clip.

### 02 Open Google Flow

Go to [labs.google/fx/tools/flow](https://labs.google/fx/tools/flow) and drag-and-drop your screenshot into a new project.

### 03 Get your prompt from ChatGPT

Open a new chat at [chatgpt.com](https://chatgpt.com) and upload the same screenshot.

Tell it what the voiceover is for this moment, and explain the scene you want to happen next in as much detail as you can — who's in frame, what they do, how the camera should move, how the shot should end.

Say this explicitly: "Don't generate an image — just write me the video generation prompt in text." Without this, ChatGPT will sometimes generate an image instead of a prompt.

### 04 Copy the prompt

ChatGPT will return one long, structured prompt. Copy it in full — the detail in it is what keeps your characters and environment consistent in the generated video.

### 05 Set up generation in Flow

Open Settings and choose your model — Veo (Fast) for a quick draft, Veo (Quality) for your final pick.

Set duration to 8 seconds, every time. Shorter clips leave the model less room to add natural motion and detail — you can always speed the clip up later in your editor.

## 06 Paste the prompt & generate

Paste the ChatGPT prompt into the prompt field alongside your uploaded frame and click Generate. Your clip will be ready in a few minutes.

## 07 Bring it into your edit

Drag the generated clip onto your timeline, adjust its playback speed to match your pacing, and cut it in like any other piece of B-roll.

### 03 / METHOD 2 — RECOMMENDED

## Template prompting

Skip the back-and-forth. Give ChatGPT a fixed structure and get a ready-to-use prompt in one message.

This is the method I default to now. Instead of explaining the scene conversationally every time, I give ChatGPT the same fixed template — and it hands back a fully structured, detailed prompt in a single reply. Faster, and far more consistent.

THE INPUT TEMPLATE — paste this into ChatGPT with your first-frame screenshot

```
voiceover: [paste the exact line that plays over this shot]

scene: [describe what should happen — who or what is already in
frame, the starting action, how it should move or evolve, and
how the shot should end or what it should reveal]

Give me a detailed AI video generation prompt for this
image-to-video clip. Do not generate an image — only write
the prompt.
```

### HOW TO FILL IT IN

**voiceover** Use the real line from your script, word for word. It keeps the pacing and mood of the generated motion in sync with what's actually being said over the shot.

**scene** Be literal, not poetic. Name the characters or objects already in frame, describe the physical action step by step, say explicitly if the camera should move, and state what the shot should reveal by the end.

**Why this one wins** — same three tools, same output quality, roughly a third of the typing. It also makes the prompt easy to hand to someone else on your team — they just fill in two lines.

## The master prompt template

This is the shape a strong prompt should take. Use it directly, or use it to check that ChatGPT's output isn't missing a section.

Use the provided image as the EXACT first frame of the video.

The video must begin directly from this frame with NO fade-in, NO fade-out, NO dissolve, NO morphing, NO scene transition, and NO replacement of the characters.

Preserve every character exactly as shown in the starting frame: [LIST KEY SUBJECTS – faces, clothing, positions, objects]. Do not regenerate or redesign them.

[BACKGROUND / SETTING ELEMENT] must remain visible and unchanged in the background throughout the beginning of the shot.

### ACTION:

Immediately after the first frame, give the existing subject(s) subtle, natural movement: [DESCRIBE THE FIRST MOVEMENT – a head turn, a step forward, a hand gesture].

[DESCRIBE HOW OTHER SUBJECTS IN FRAME REACT OR MOVE].

### IMPORTANT:

Subjects must physically move from their starting positions. Do not make them disappear, dissolve, or teleport. Do not replace them with new characters. Do not morph the background into another environment.

### CAMERA:

Use a smooth cinematic tracking camera. Start with the exact original framing, then after ~1 second begin a subtle [PUSH-IN / TRACKING / PAN] toward [SUBJECT]. Maintain realistic parallax between subject and background.

### CHARACTER PERFORMANCE:

[DESCRIBE HOW THE MAIN SUBJECT SHOULD BEHAVE – pace, expression, tone]. No exaggerated acting. No sudden gestures unless specified.

**CONTINUATION OF THE STORY:**

As the shot continues, gradually reveal [WHAT COMES INTO FRAME NEXT] within the same continuous environment — do not cut or transition to it, let the camera arrive there naturally.  
[DESCRIBE THE FINAL BEAT / PAYOFF OF THE SHOT].

**VISUAL MESSAGE:**

The physical action must communicate: [YOUR CORE POINT — the idea this shot is proving, in one sentence].

**REALISM:**

Ultra-photorealistic [STYLE — e.g. historical documentary] style.  
Realistic movement mechanics, cloth/material physics, natural facial and eye movement, physically accurate lighting and shadows, subtle cinematic depth of field. No fantasy aesthetic. No modern objects unless specified. No text. No subtitles. No logos.

NO FADE. NO DISSOLVE. NO MORPH. NO CROSSFADE. NO TELEPORTATION.  
NO DISAPPEARING CHARACTERS. NO ENVIRONMENT TRANSFORMATION.

Everything must happen through continuous physical movement inside the same shot.

[ASPECT RATIO — e.g. Vertical 9:16 / Horizontal 16:9]. Smooth cinematic tracking shot. Seamless continuation from the provided first frame.

## Five things that actually move the needle

Small details that separate a clean, usable clip from a wasted generation.

### 01 Always generate at 8 seconds

More duration gives the model more room to add natural detail and motion. Speed-ramp the clip down afterward in your editor if you need it punchier — that's easier than trying to stretch a short, thin clip.

## **02 Tell ChatGPT not to generate an image**

Say it directly: you want the prompt text only. Left unsaid, ChatGPT will sometimes generate an image instead of writing you a prompt.

## **03 Screenshot in Full HD, minimum**

1920×1080 or higher. A soft, compressed first frame produces a soft, inconsistent generated clip — quality in is quality out.

## **04 Be literal about "no fade / no dissolve / no morph"**

If you want one continuous shot, say so explicitly and repeatedly. Left to itself, the model will default to cutting or transitioning between beats.

## **05 Feed the real voiceover line into every prompt**

It keeps the pacing and emotional tone of the generated motion locked to what's actually being said over the shot — not just to the visuals.

THAT'S THE FULL WORKFLOW

# Screenshot to shot, in three tools.

Capture the frame. Write the prompt — conversationally or with the template, your call. Generate at 8 seconds. Bring it home in your edit. That's the entire pipeline, and it's the same one I use in my own content.

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More of my work: <https://zohaib20128-cyber.github.io/Portfolio/>

More breakdowns like this drop regularly on my pages — comment "AI" on any post and this guide gets sent straight to you.